

ISSUE 53

AUGUST 11, 2026

LAST WEEK IN TÜRKİYE

A weekly roundup of the top news
and developments in Türkiye



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BIANET

MORE THAN 230 CHP MAYORS JOIN ÖZEL'S NEW PARTY



The newly formed New Party says 232 mayors, including 28 city mayors, have defected from the CHP, potentially pushing the total above 300 by month's end and leaving the CHP with fewer than half of the municipalities it won in 2024.

The defections come amid a major corruption crackdown and legal challenges targeting the CHP and its leader Özgür Özel, which Özel says are politically motivated efforts to weaken the opposition; the government denies this.



TURKISH PARLIAMENT PASSES THE “FRAMEWORK LAW”



The Turkish Parliament has approved the 12-article “Framework Law,” formally titled the Law on Strengthening National Solidarity and Social Integration, as part of the government’s “Terror-Free Türkiye” process. The legislation was adopted by the General Assembly on August 10 following a vote of 467 in favor, 87 against and 7 abstentions. The law establishes legal measures related to the disarmament and dissolution process of the PKK/KCK, including provisions concerning ongoing investigations, prosecutions and sentences.



INVESTIGATION INTO TIP SPOKESPERSON SERA KADIGIL FOR “INSULTING THE PRESIDENT



Ankara Chief Public Prosecutor's Office announced that it has launched an ex officio investigation into Sera Kadıgil, spokesperson for the Workers' Party of Türkiye (TİP) and an Istanbul MP, over remarks she made at a rally in İzmir.

The investigation concerns alleged “insulting the President” and “threatening the President” under Articles 299 and 310/2 of the Turkish Penal Code, respectively.



AN INVESTIGATION HAS BEEN LAUNCHED INTO İYİ PARTY GROUP DEPUTY CHAIR TURHAN ÇÖMEZ.



Ankara Chief Public Prosecutor's Office has launched an investigation into İYİ Party Group Deputy Chair Turhan Çömez for allegedly spreading misleading information after he claimed that a riot had broken out at Sincan No. 1 Prison. The investigation was opened under Article 217/A of the Turkish Penal Code, which criminalizes publicly spreading misleading information.



KUŞADASI MAYOR GÜNEL MAKES CLAIM ABOUT OPERATION



Detained former Kuşadası Mayor Ömer Günel alleges that businessman Ferdi Zenginoğlu, whose testimony reportedly contributed to the latest bribery and extortion investigation into Kuşadası Municipality, had sent him a letter months earlier demanding money and threatening to become a cooperating witness if he refused. Günel claims the subsequent arrests largely followed the scenario described in that letter and argues that the early-morning operations and media coverage risk creating a public perception of guilt before the judicial process is completed.



PARLIAMENT PASSES LAW INCREASING PRISON TERMS FOR MINORS



Parliament passed amendments tightening juvenile sentencing, including longer prison terms for children aged 12–17, separate detention rules, and criminal penalties for negligent firearm storage that gives children access to guns.

Critics argue the law focuses on harsher punishment rather than addressing underlying causes of juvenile crime, such as school disengagement, inadequate parental support, and recruitment of minors by criminal organizations.



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ENVIRONMENT MINISTRY, COMPANY PUSH FOR NEW UNITS AT COAL PLANT LINKED TO SEVERE POLLUTION



The Environment Ministry and Çelikler Holding are appealing a court decision that canceled environmental approval for two new coal-fired units at Afşin-Elbistan, after the court found the EIA inadequate on health, water, farmland, ecosystem, and cumulative pollution impacts. The appeal comes despite separate findings that an existing unit fails to meet environmental standards, highlighting a conflict between Türkiye's planned coal expansion and its climate commitments ahead of COP31, which Türkiye will host in November.



DORUK MADENCİLİK WORKERS DETAINED AGAIN IN ANKARA



Doruk Madencilik workers were detained again in Ankara on August 10 while protesting over unpaid wages and other outstanding labor claims. The miners, along with workers from Eti Gümüş, gathered outside the Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources to demand payment of wages and compensation. Police intervened and detained dozens of workers during the protest. The workers had previously held demonstrations in Ankara over the same demands, including protests earlier this year.



VETERANS PROTEST FOR EQUAL RIGHTS



Veterans and relatives of fallen soldiers have been protesting in Ankara's Güvenpark, calling for improvements to their legal and social rights. The group says veterans who served as enlisted soldiers and those who served as officers or non-commissioned officers receive different benefits despite having suffered injuries in the same circumstances. Protesters have called for equal rights and benefits. The police intervention came as the group attempted to leave Güvenpark and continue their demonstration.



STORKS DIE FROM ELECTROCUTION ALONG MIGRATION ROUTES IN TÜRKİYE



Storks migrating through Türkiye are dying after coming into contact with electrical infrastructure, with recent deaths reported in multiple provinces. At least 50 storks were found dead in Istanbul, while similar incidents have been reported in Mersin. Wildlife groups are calling for measures to make power lines and other electrical infrastructure safer for migrating birds.



COURT REJECTS CHALLENGE TO WOMEN'S REGISTRY TRANSFER



Türkiye's Constitutional Court has rejected a challenge to the provision requiring a married woman's civil registry record to be transferred to her husband's family registry. The court ruled by majority that the provision is not unconstitutional, reasoning that the registry is an administrative record and that the transfer does not directly or decisively affect a woman's legal status or concrete interests. Five Constitutional Court members dissented, arguing that the provision creates a gender-based difference between spouses.



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TOP COURT FINDS VIOLATION IN UNIVERSITY'S REFUSAL TO REISSUE TRANS MAN'S DIPLOMA



Turkey's Constitutional Court ruled that Bartın University violated a trans man's right to privacy by refusing to reissue his diploma with his legally changed name and male gender information, finding that the decision exposed sensitive personal details and was not sufficiently justified. The court ordered a retrial and awarded E.D. ₺40,446.90 in legal costs, while two judges dissented, arguing that adding a note to the original diploma was sufficient.